

Gaming Goes Digital-Only, Hollywood Cashes In on Game IP, Fans Vibe-Code with Claude

TL;DR

- ▶ Sony ends physical PS5 game sales in 2028 and GTA VI ships digital-only, accelerating gaming's shift to subscription-style cloud play, with usage caps and ads already arriving on Xbox.
- ▶ Hollywood's biggest recent hits are built on video-game IP – Mario, Minecraft, Sonic, Fallout, and The Last of Us have each cleared \$960M+ – and studios are launching in-house game arms to mine their own catalogs.
- ▶ Consumers are vibe-coding their own small games with AI apps like Claude, Meta's Pocket, and Roblox's Build, though one builder's DIY GTA clone hit real technical and legal limits.

AI NEWS

the news — then what it means for you

Consumers are vibe-coding their own video games with AI apps. Tools like Meta's Pocket and Roblox's Build let anyone prompt their way to a small, playable game; an Inc. reporter built a browser game after an hour of prompting Claude, while another builder tried to vibe-code a GTA clone to beat GTA VI to market but hit technical and legal walls and bought a PS5 instead.

What it means for you: Low-code, prompt-built creation is moving from business tools into consumer entertainment – a live example of how fast a prototype can go from novelty to real product, and where the IP/legal guardrails still bite.

Source: Morning Brew (Gaming Brew)

Sony will sell new PlayStation games as digital downloads only starting in 2028, and Grand Theft Auto VI will launch digital-only too. Take-Two's CEO predicts a coming cloud-gaming surge, but Xbox already added monthly streaming limits to Game Pass and is testing ad-supported streaming to offset rising costs.

PM angle: The tension here – you don't fully own what you 'buy,' and usage caps arrive only after adoption – mirrors the pushback clients hit when moving customers to consumption-based SaaS pricing. A live case study for pricing and governance conversations.

Conversation starter: *Sony's going digital-only on PS5 games by 2028 – anyone else think the 'you don't actually own it' backlash is a preview of what happens when we push clients toward usage-based pricing?*

Source: Morning Brew (Gaming Brew)

Video-game adaptations are now some of Hollywood's biggest hits. The Super Mario Galaxy Movie and A Minecraft Movie each topped \$960M worldwide, the Sonic franchise has cleared \$1B since 2020, and Fallout and The Last of Us succeeded on TV – prompting Paramount and Warner Bros. Discovery to each launch in-house game studios to mine their own film/TV IP for games.

PM angle: A clean example of an IP portfolio monetized across every channel instead of siloed by medium – worth citing when a client asks how to get more value out of an existing brand or content library.

Conversation starter: *Paramount and Warner Bros. Discovery are both building game studios just to reuse their own movie and TV IP – is there a version of that inside our own content or product portfolio?*

Source: Morning Brew (Gaming Brew)

Collegiate esports scholarships are scaling fast. The National Association of Collegiate Esports now covers 200+ schools and 16,000 student-athletes with \$20,000–\$30,000 scholarships typical; at one New Jersey recruiting event, 29 colleges made 181 offers totaling \$99,000, including two full rides.

PM angle: No direct relevance to your work, general awareness only.

Conversation starter: *Did you know kids are getting full-ride scholarships for esports now? Recruiting for gaming talent is basically running like a varsity sports program.*

Source: Morning Brew (Gaming Brew)